STUDENT PROJECTS LABORATORY - 930 KINNEAR RD

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE (SOP) | ASSET: SAW-03 | TAG: CHOP-01

Abrasive Chop Saw

Facility Zone: Zone 4: Cutting, Saws & Drilling (SAW) | Supervisor: Max Wright (Sr. Instructional Lab Supervisor)

1. REQUIRED PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT (PPE)

1. ANSI Z87.1 Safety Glasses + Face Shield
2. Hearing Protection
3. Heavy Leather Gloves for Raw Stock Handling Only
4. Hair & Loose Clothing Secured

2. PRIMARY OPERATIONAL HAZARDS

1. Abrasive wheel shattering if workpiece shifts or binds in cut
2. High-velocity hot spark stream fire hazard
3. Severe burn hazard on freshly cut steel edges

3. BEFORE OPERATION CHECKLIST

1. Verify retractable lower guard moves freely without sticking.
2. Inspect abrasive wheel for cracks, chips, or excessive wear.
3. Clamp ALL stock securely in vise (NEVER hold stock by hand).

4. DURING OPERATION SAFETY RULES

1. Keep hands >= 4 inches away from blade path.
2. Aim spark deflector away from trash bins and flammables.
3. Feed down with steady moderate pressure-do not force or twist wheel.

5. AFTER USE & SHOWROOM CLEANUP

1. Let abrasive blade coast to a complete stop before raising saw head.
2. Allow hot cut stock to cool or handle with pliers/leather gloves.

EMERGENCY SHUTDOWN & INCIDENT PROTOCOL:

Release trigger immediately and keep head lowered until wheel stops spinning.